Introduction

DevArt Utils is an advanced administration toolkit for Joomla websites, designed to simplify cache management, performance control, diagnostics, and daily maintenance.

It combines powerful tools in one easy-to-use interface, including:

- Cache Rules management
- Cache Diagnostics
- Cache Preview
- Cloudflare integration and purge tools
- Google Analytics Realtime dashboard
- Quick maintenance actions
- System checks and useful admin shortcuts

DevArt Utils is especially useful for news portals, business websites, multi-site environments, and high-traffic Joomla installations where speed and efficient cache control are important.

Minimum Requirements

To install and run DevArt Utils, your server should meet the following minimum requirements:

- Joomla 6.x
- PHP 8.0 or higher
- PHP cURL extension enabled
- PHP OpenSSL extension enabled
- PHP JSON extension enabled
- Standard Joomla administrator access

Optional Integrations

Some advanced features require external services:

- Cloudflare API Token (for cache purge and statistics)
- Google Analytics 4 Property ID and Service Account JSON (for realtime analytics)

Recommended Environment

For best performance, DevArt Utils is recommended on:

- PHP 8.1+
- Modern hosting with SSD storage
- HTTPS enabled websites
- Active caching strategy
- Cloudflare

Goal of DevArt Utils

The goal of DevArt Utils is to give Joomla administrators a practical control center where speed, cache behavior, traffic signals, and maintenance tools are managed quickly and safely from one place.

Dashboard, Cloudflare Tools & GA Realtime

The DevArt Utils dashboard is designed to give administrators a fast operational overview of their website.

Instead of opening many different tools separately, you can manage performance, cache, traffic signals, and quick-access utilities from one central location.

1. Dashboard Overview

Go to:

DevArt Utils → Dashboard

The dashboard combines important daily tools in one screen.

GA Realtime Summary

If Google Analytics 4 integration is enabled, the dashboard displays:

- Active users in the last 30 minutes
- Current traffic level
- Last update time

Traffic indicators may show levels such as:

- Low
- Normal
- High
- Very High

This helps you instantly understand live website activity.

Why This Is Useful

Before clearing cache, updating modules, or changing settings, you can quickly see whether traffic is currently low or very busy.

For high-traffic websites, this can prevent unnecessary disruption.

Quick Action Buttons

The dashboard provides fast access to core tools:

- Cache Rules
- Cache Diagnostics
- Cache Preview
- Cloudflare
- GA Realtime
- Settings

This saves time during daily administration.

Latest Joomla News

The dashboard can display recent updates from official Joomla sources.

Examples:

- New Joomla releases
- Security announcements
- Bugfix releases
- Official project news

This helps administrators stay updated without leaving the control panel.

Admin Shortcuts

The dashboard may also include one-click shortcuts to useful external tools.

Examples:

Google Tools

- Google Search Console
- Google Analytics
- Google AdSense
- Google Ad Manager
- Google APIs
- Looker Studio

SEO / Web Tools

- Facebook Debugger
- WebPageTest
- DNS Checker
- Speedtest
- SimilarWeb
- WAVE accessibility checker

Hosting / CDN

- Cloudflare
- OVHcloud
- Registrar panels

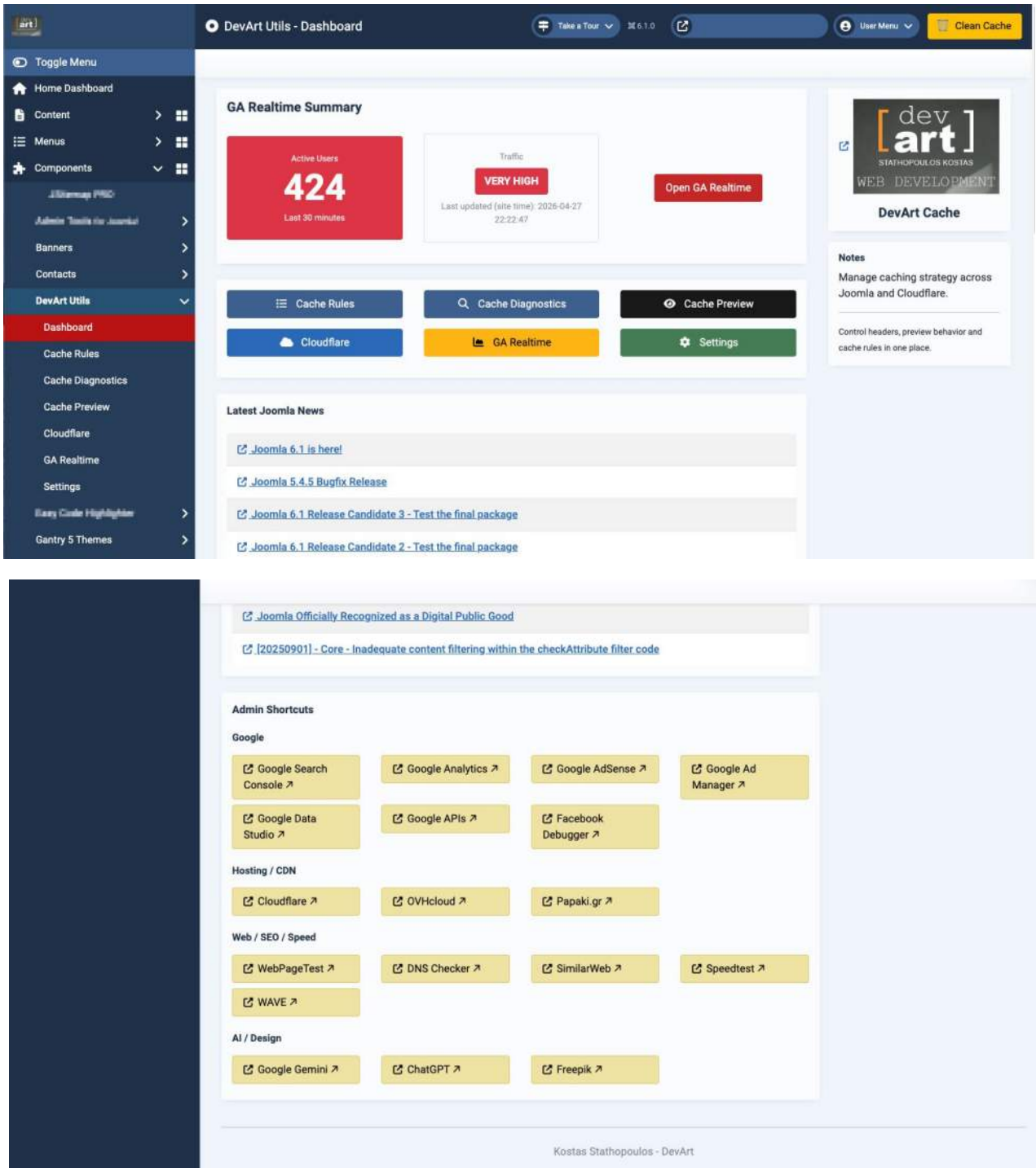
AI / Design

- ChatGPT
- Google Gemini
- Freepik

Why Shortcuts Matter

Administrators often use the same tools every day.

Having them inside Joomla saves time and improves workflow.



2. Cloudflare Submenu

Go to:

DevArt Utils → Cloudflare

This section connects Joomla with Cloudflare for fast cache management and useful statistics.

Connection Status

At the top, DevArt Utils shows:

- Connected status
- Zone name
- Zone ID
- Purge host target

This confirms that the Cloudflare connection is working correctly.

Test Connection

Checks:

- API token validity
- Zone access
- Correct permissions
- Domain resolution

Use this after creating or changing credentials.

Purge Everything

Clears the full Cloudflare cache for the entire zone.

Use Only When Necessary

This removes all cached content globally and forces Cloudflare to rebuild everything from your server.

That means:

- More origin server load
- Slower visitor response temporarily
- Higher resource usage

Recommended only after:

- major redesigns
- global CSS/JS changes
- full migration
- serious cache corruption

Purge This Site Cache

Clears only the configured hostname or subdomain.

Examples:

- mydomain.com
- news.mydomain.com
- shop.mydomain.com

This is the recommended daily purge option.

Why It Is Better

Instead of purging the entire zone, you refresh only the affected site.

Useful for multi-site Joomla environments.

Purge Specific URL

Allows purging only one exact URL.

Example:

- Homepage
- Latest News page
- One article page
- Category page

Best Practice Examples

After publishing breaking news:

Purge only:

- homepage
- latest news page

After correcting one article:

Purge only that article URL.

This is much smarter than purging everything.

Purge History

Stores recent purge targets.

Allows one-click re-purge of commonly used URLs.

Useful for:

- homepage
- category pages
- feed pages

Cloudflare Statistics

The Cloudflare page may show 7-day operational statistics.

Examples:

- Total Requests
- Cached Requests
- Uncached Requests
- Unique Visitors
- Cache Hit Ratio
- Data Served
- Cached Data

Why Cache Hit Ratio Matters

This percentage shows how much traffic is served directly by Cloudflare versus how much reaches your server.

Example:

70% Hit Ratio

70% served by Cloudflare
30% served by origin server

Good result.

90%+

Excellent for static websites.

40% or lower

Often means poor cache setup or highly dynamic traffic.

What Affects This Ratio

Mainly your Cloudflare configuration:

- Cache Rules
- Page Rules
- Edge TTL
- Bypass rules
- Cookie behavior
- Query string handling

And secondarily your Joomla headers.

Important Note

DevArt Utils helps control headers and purging, but the final behavior is strongly affected by your own Cloudflare settings.

For best results, configure both systems correctly.

Cloudflare Cache Rules Display

DevArt Utils may also show Cloudflare Cache Rules in read-only mode.

This helps compare:

- Joomla rules
- Cloudflare rules

Very useful when debugging mismatches.

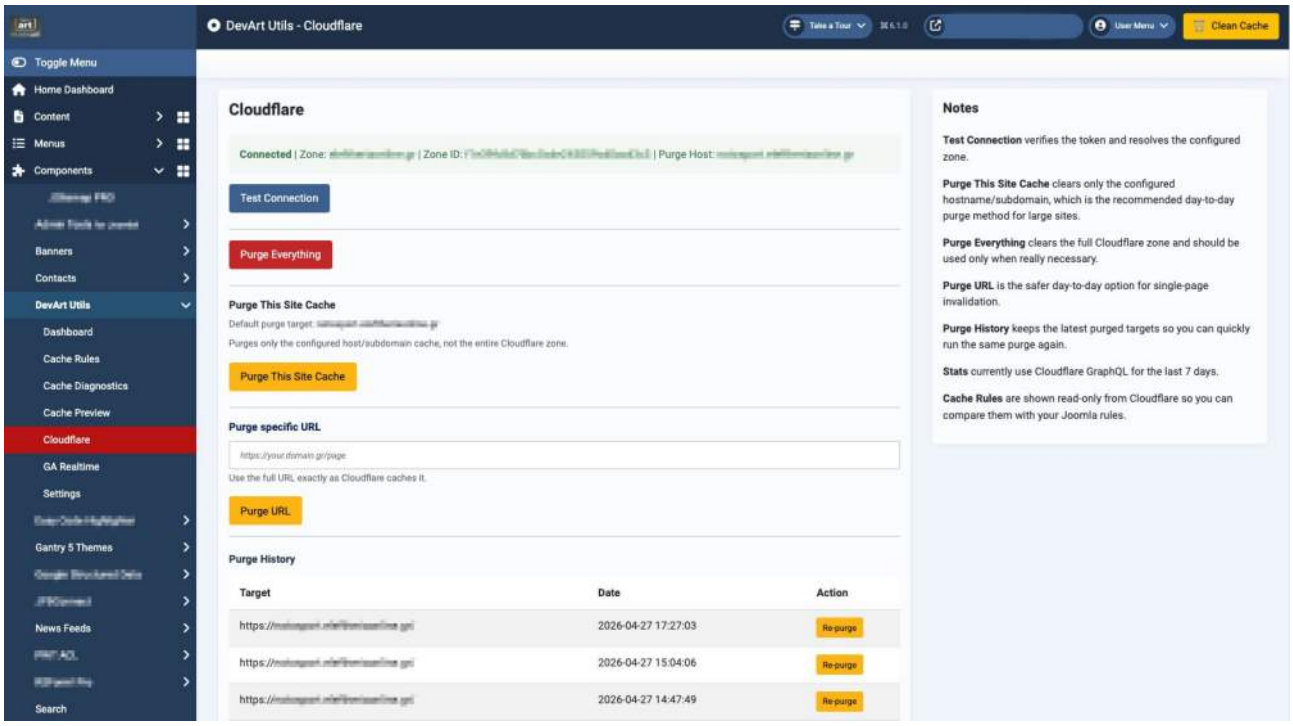
Recommended Daily Workflow

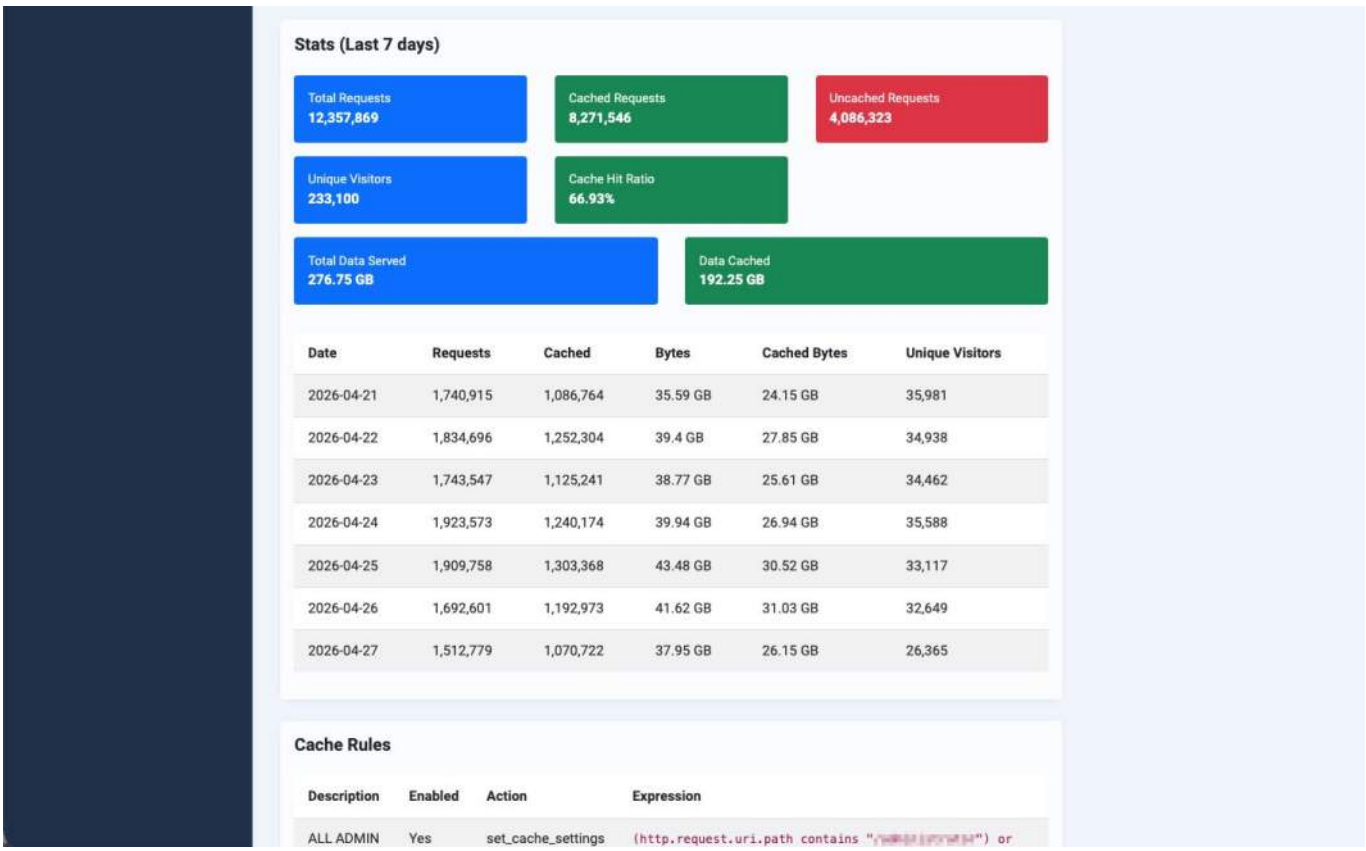
Instead of Purge Everything:

Use:

- Purge Specific URL
- Purge This Site Cache

Use full purge only when absolutely needed.





Stats (Last 7 days)

Total Requests 12,357,869

Cached Requests 8,271,546

Uncached Requests 4,086,323

Unique Visitors 233,100

Cache Hit Ratio 66.93%

Total Data Served 276.75 GB

Data Cached 192.25 GB

Date	Requests	Cached	Bytes	Cached Bytes	Unique Visitors
2026-04-21	1,740,915	1,086,764	35.59 GB	24.15 GB	35,981
2026-04-22	1,834,696	1,252,304	39.4 GB	27.85 GB	34,938
2026-04-23	1,743,547	1,125,241	38.77 GB	25.61 GB	34,462
2026-04-24	1,923,573	1,240,174	39.94 GB	26.94 GB	35,588
2026-04-25	1,909,758	1,303,368	43.48 GB	30.52 GB	33,117
2026-04-26	1,692,601	1,192,973	41.62 GB	31.03 GB	32,649
2026-04-27	1,512,779	1,070,722	37.95 GB	26.15 GB	26,365

Cache Rules

Description	Enabled	Action	Expression
ALL ADMIN	Yes	set_cache_settings	(http.request.uri.path contains "[illegible]") or

3. GA Realtime

Go to:

DevArt Utils → GA Realtime

This section shows live traffic inside Joomla administrator using Google Analytics 4 data.

What It Displays

Active Users

Current visitors from the last 30 minutes.

Traffic Status

Overall load level:

- Low
- Normal
- High

- Very High

Last Updated Time

Shows freshness of displayed data.

Top Live Page Titles

Displays the most visited pages right now.

Examples:

- Homepage
- Breaking news article
- Sports article
- Local news page

Why This Is Extremely Useful for High-Traffic Sites

For news portals or busy websites, traffic changes quickly.

Realtime data helps administrators decide:

- when to purge cache
- when to avoid changes
- which pages are hot right now
- where users are concentrated

Important Warning About Full Cloudflare Purges

Do **not** clear the full Cloudflare cache during heavy traffic unless necessary.

Why:

Cloudflare will request many uncached pages again from your server.

This can cause:

- sudden CPU spikes
- slower page loads
- server stress
- higher database load

Especially dangerous on large news websites.

Smarter Purging Strategy

During high traffic:

Use targeted purges only.

Examples:

Publish breaking story

Purge:

- homepage
- latest news page
- story URL

Correct old article

Purge:

- article URL only

Update sports category

Purge:

- sports category page

Use GA Realtime Before Purging

If active users are:

Very High

Delay full purge if possible.

Low / Normal

Safer time for broader maintenance.

Auto Refresh

GA Realtime may support automatic refresh so admins can monitor traffic continuously.

Useful during:

- elections
- breaking news
- sports finals

- emergencies
- viral traffic spikes

Best Practice for News Websites

1. Check GA Realtime first
2. If traffic is very high, avoid full purge
3. Purge only affected URLs
4. Use full purge later during calmer traffic

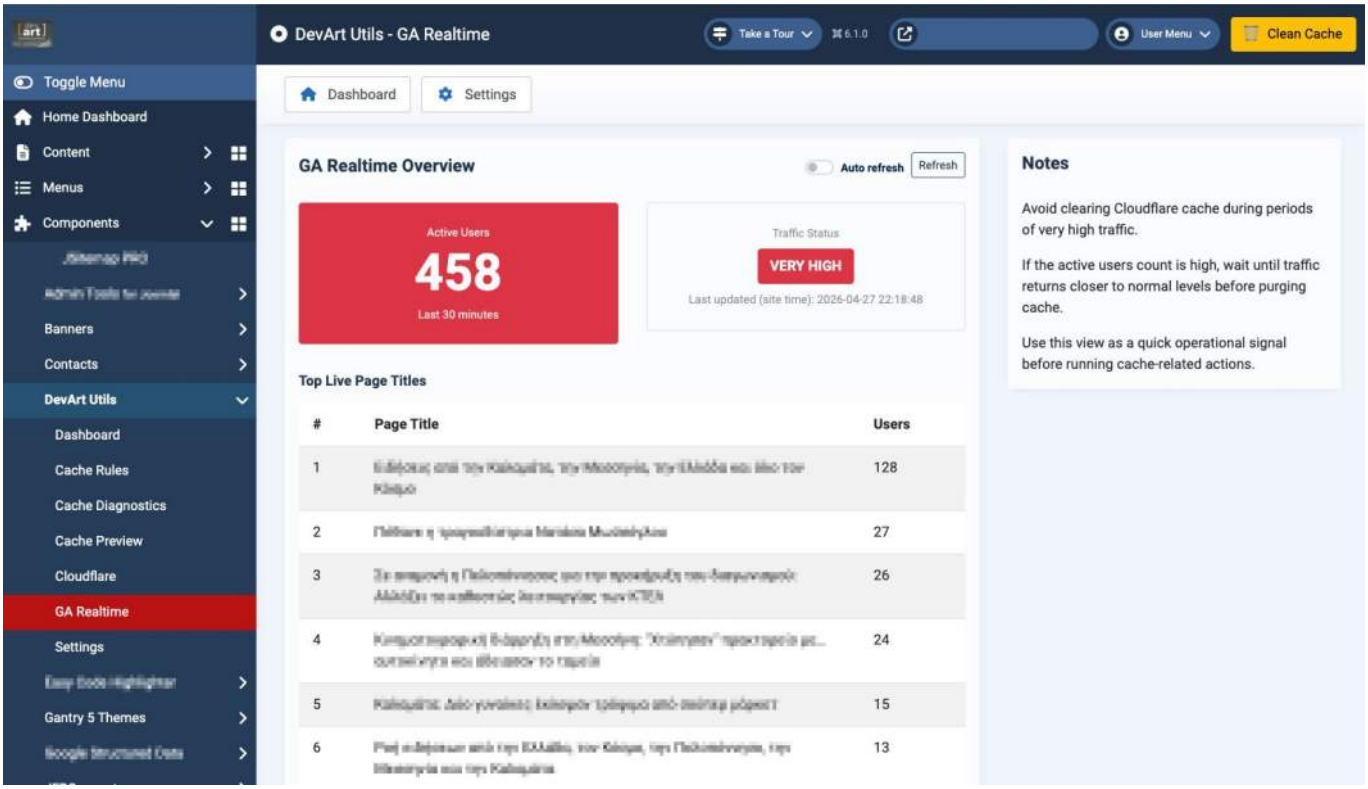
Final Advice

The combination of:

- Dashboard overview
- Cloudflare tools
- GA Realtime

turns DevArt Utils into a practical control center for serious Joomla websites.

Instead of guessing, administrators can make decisions based on real traffic and smart cache management.



Cache Rules, Cache Diagnostics & Cache Preview

DevArt Utils includes powerful tools that help you manage caching behavior between Joomla, your web server, and Cloudflare.

These tools are designed to make advanced caching easier, safer, and more understandable even for non-technical users.

1. Cache Rules

What Are Cache Rules?

Cache Rules define how HTTP caching headers are applied to specific URLs or groups of URLs on your website.

Instead of using one global cache setting for the entire website, you can create smart rules for different areas such as:

- Homepage
- RSS feeds
- Category pages
- Article pages
- Static landing pages
- Admin area
- Search pages
- Special campaign URLs

This gives you full control over performance and freshness.

Why Use Cache Rules?

Different pages need different cache behavior.

Examples:

- Homepage may need shorter cache time
- RSS feeds may need aggressive Cloudflare caching
- Admin area should never be cached
- Static pages may use long cache times

With Cache Rules, you decide exactly how each section behaves.

Important Recommendation

Create only a **small number of useful rules**.

Do **not** create many unnecessary rules.

A clean setup with 3–10 well-planned rules is usually better than 50 confusing ones.

Good examples:

- Admin bypass
- RSS cache
- Homepage fast refresh
- Articles medium cache
- Static pages long cache

Cache Rules List

The Cache Rules screen shows all existing rules.

Each row includes:

- Title
- Enabled / Disabled status
- Priority
- Group
- Match Type
- Match Value
- Cache Mode
- Browser TTL
- Edge TTL
- SWR
- SIE

Toolbar Actions

New

Create a new rule.

Enable / Disable

Turn selected rules on or off without deleting them.

Useful for testing.

Delete

Remove selected rules.

Export All

Exports all rules as a backup file.

Useful when:

- moving to another site
- cloning settings
- creating backups before changes

Export Selected

Export only chosen rules.

Useful for sharing a specific setup.

Import

Import previously exported rules.

Perfect for:

- staging to production
- multiple Joomla sites
- restoring backups

Priority – Very Important

Rules run from the **lowest priority number first**.

Example:

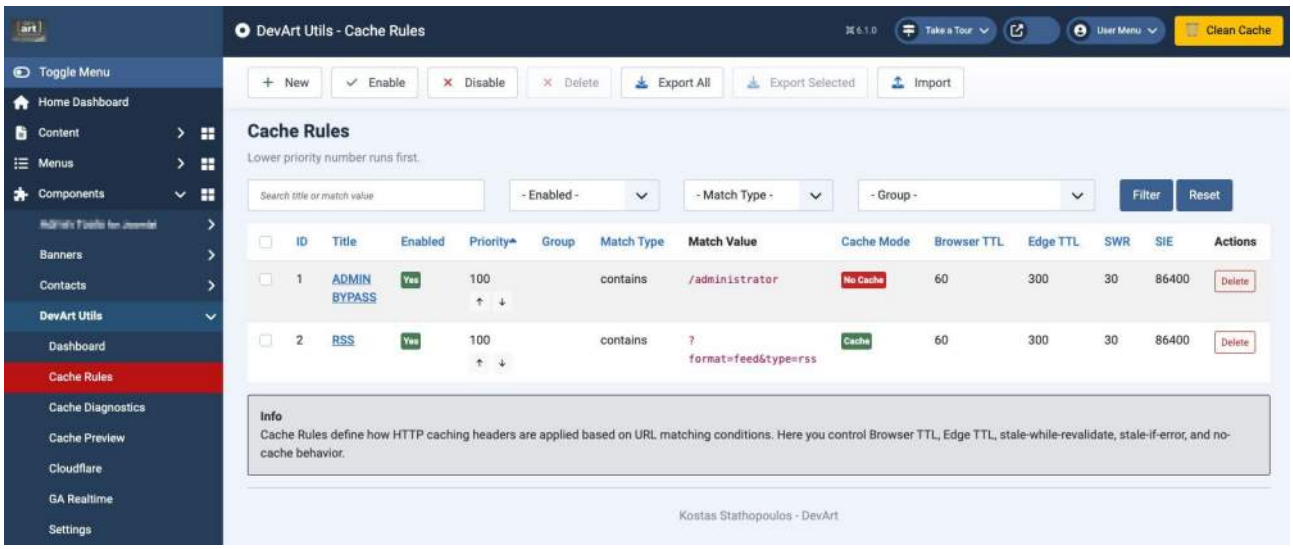
- Priority 100 = checked before Priority 200
- Priority 200 = checked before Priority 300

The **first enabled matching rule wins**.

So always place more specific rules above general ones.

Example:

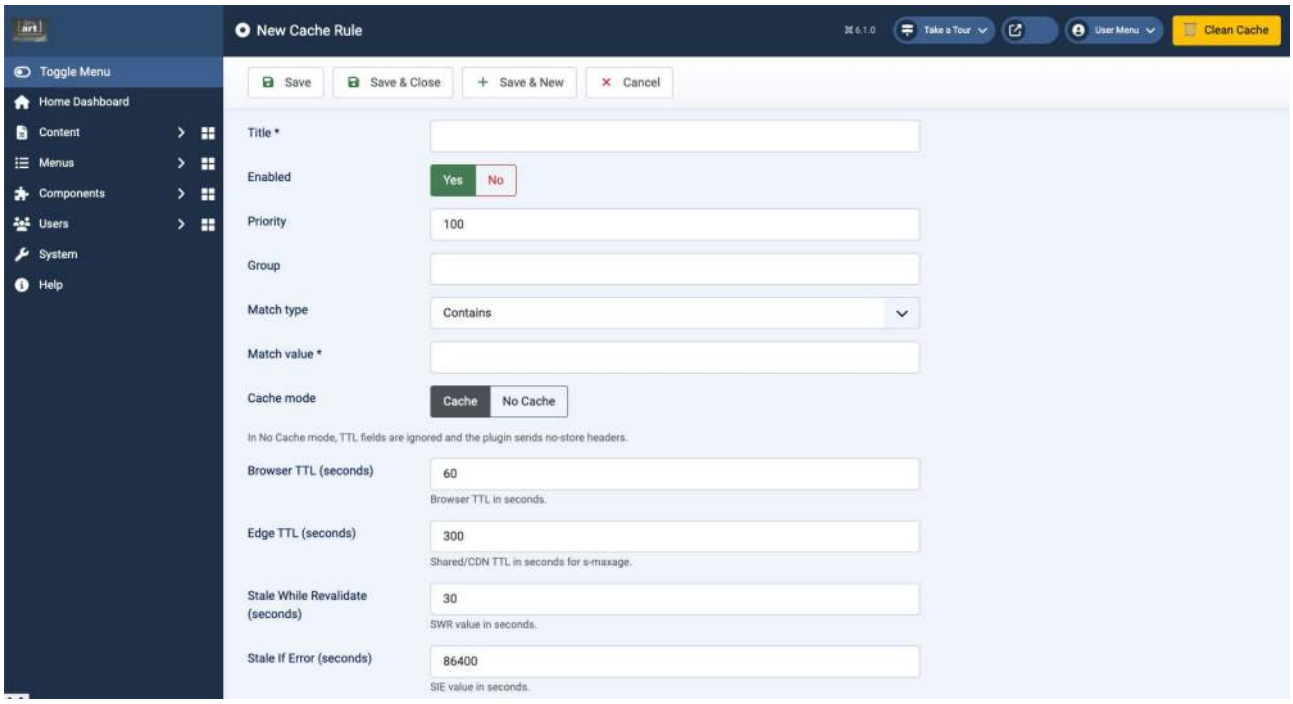
- RSS rule = 100
- Homepage rule = 200
- Generic articles = 300



Creating a New Cache Rule

Go to:

DevArt Utils → Cache Rules → New



Fields Explained

Title

Internal rule name.

Examples:

- RSS Cache
- Homepage Fast Cache
- Admin Bypass

Use clear names.

Enabled

Yes / No

If disabled, the rule is ignored.

Priority

Execution order.

Lower number runs first.

Recommended:

100, 200, 300, 400…

This leaves room for future rules.

Group

Optional label for organization.

Examples:

- News
- Feeds
- Admin
- Testing

Useful on large websites.

Match Type

Defines how the URL is checked.

Examples:

- Contains
- Starts With
- Exact Match

Use the simplest one possible.

Match Value

The text pattern to detect.

Examples:

- /administrator
- ?format=feed&type=rss
- /news/
- /sports/

Cache Mode

Cache

Normal caching headers are sent.

No Cache

The plugin sends no-store / bypass style headers.

Use for:

- Admin pages
- Dynamic forms
- Checkout pages
- Sensitive pages

Browser TTL (seconds)

How long visitor browsers may keep cached content.

Example:

60 = 1 minute

Edge TTL (seconds)

How long CDN / Cloudflare edge servers keep cache.

Example:

300 = 5 minutes

SWR – Stale While Revalidate

Allows expired cache to be served while fresh content is fetched in background.

Improves speed.

Example:

30

SIE – Stale If Error

Allows old cache to be served if the origin server fails.

Excellent for stability during downtime.

Example:

86400 = 24 hours

Best Practice Example

RSS Feed Rule:

- Match Value: `?format=feed&type=rss`
- Cache Mode: Cache
- Browser TTL: 60
- Edge TTL: 300

Admin Rule:

- Match Value: `/administrator`
- Cache Mode: No Cache

2. Cache Diagnostics

What Is Cache Diagnostics?

This tool checks real URLs and helps you understand:

- Which rule matched
- Which headers should be sent
- What live headers are actually returned
- Whether Cloudflare is HIT / MISS / DYNAMIC
- If another system is overriding headers

This is one of the most powerful troubleshooting tools in DevArt Utils.

Why Use It?

Use Cache Diagnostics when:

- cache is not working as expected
- Cloudflare ignores TTL values

- some pages cache, others do not
- RSS caching needs testing
- another plugin changes headers
- server config overrides Joomla headers

How To Use It

Go to:

DevArt Utils → Cache Diagnostics

Enter one or more URLs.

One URL per line.

Then click:

Run Diagnostics

Single URL Example

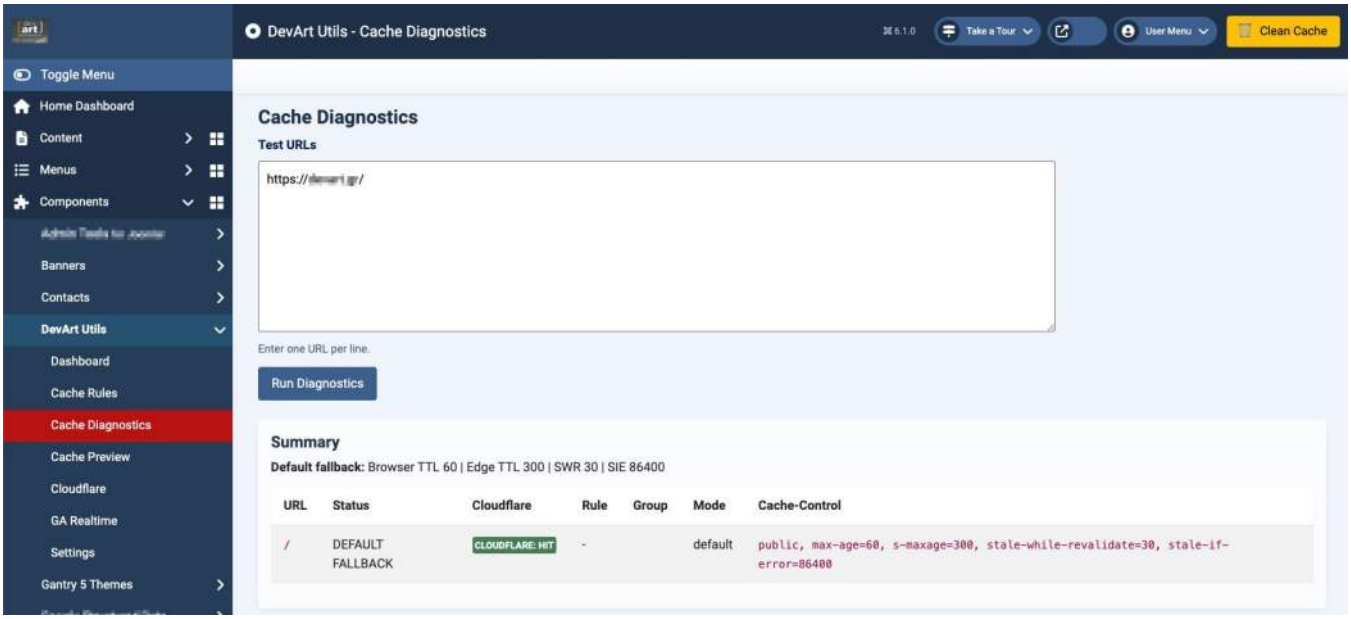
You test:

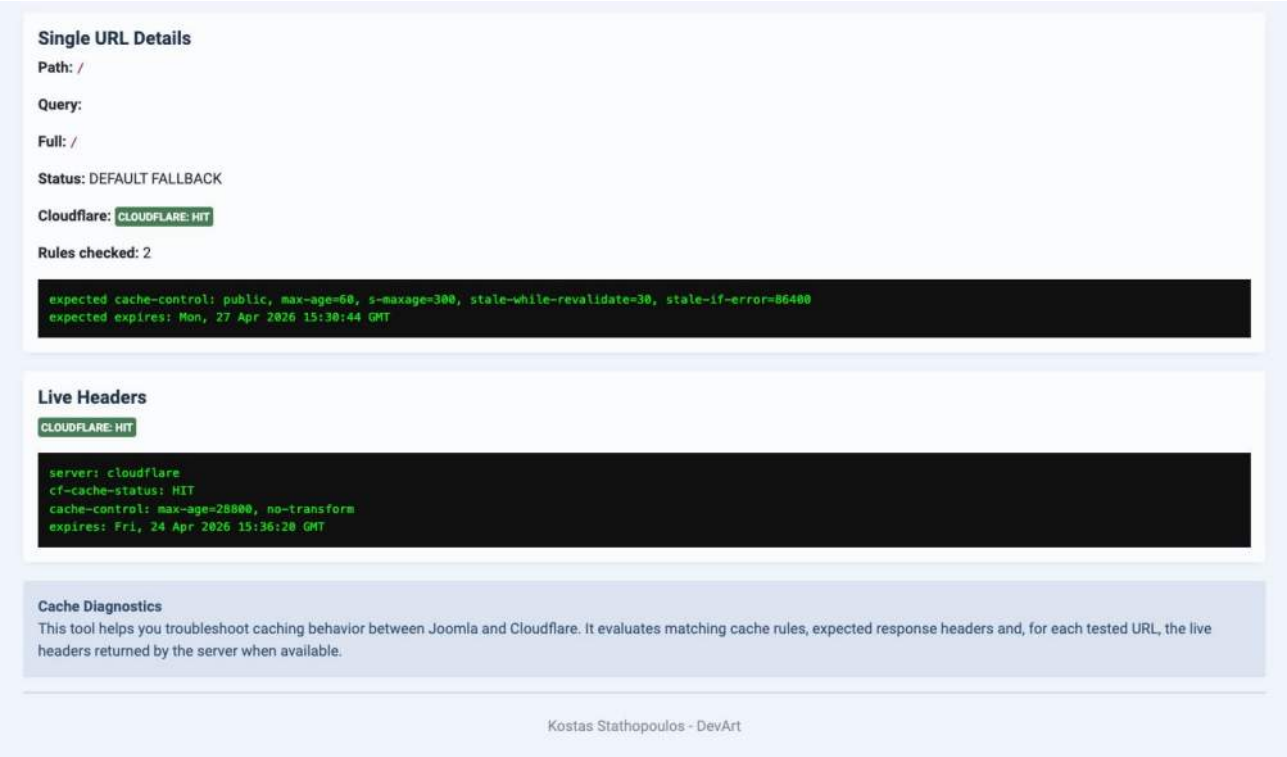
`https://yourdomain.com/`

The report may show:

- Status: Default Fallback
- Cloudflare: HIT
- Expected cache-control
- Live response headers

This means no custom rule matched, so default settings were used.





Another Single URL Example

You test:

`https://yourdomain.com/news/article`

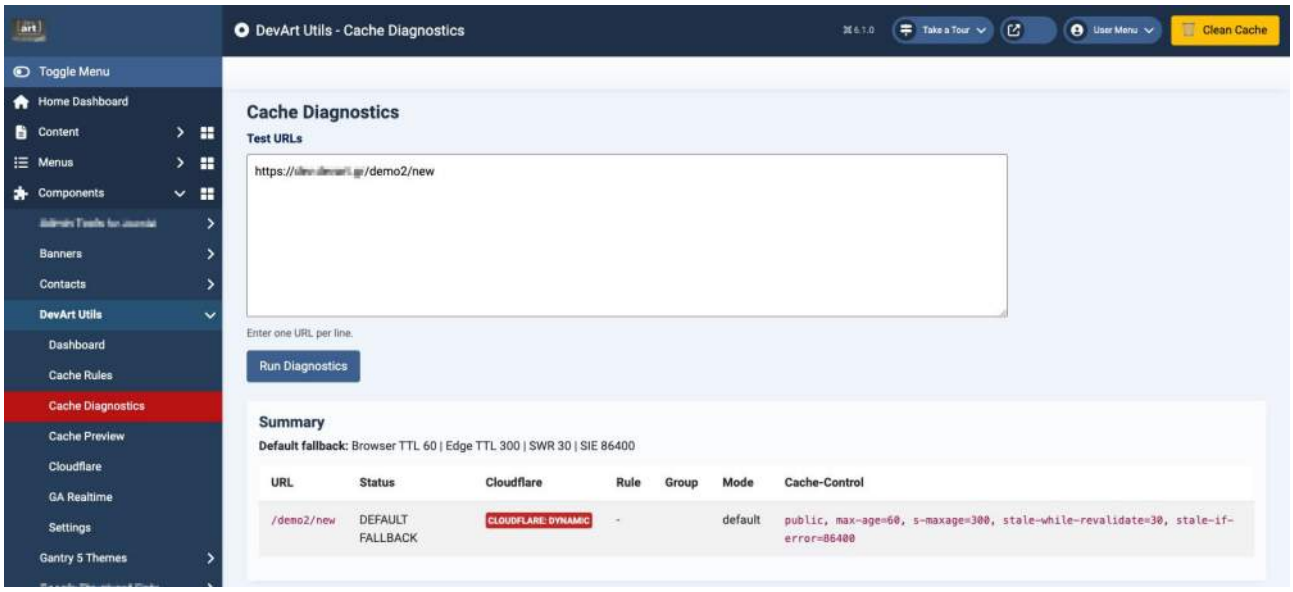
Cloudflare may show:

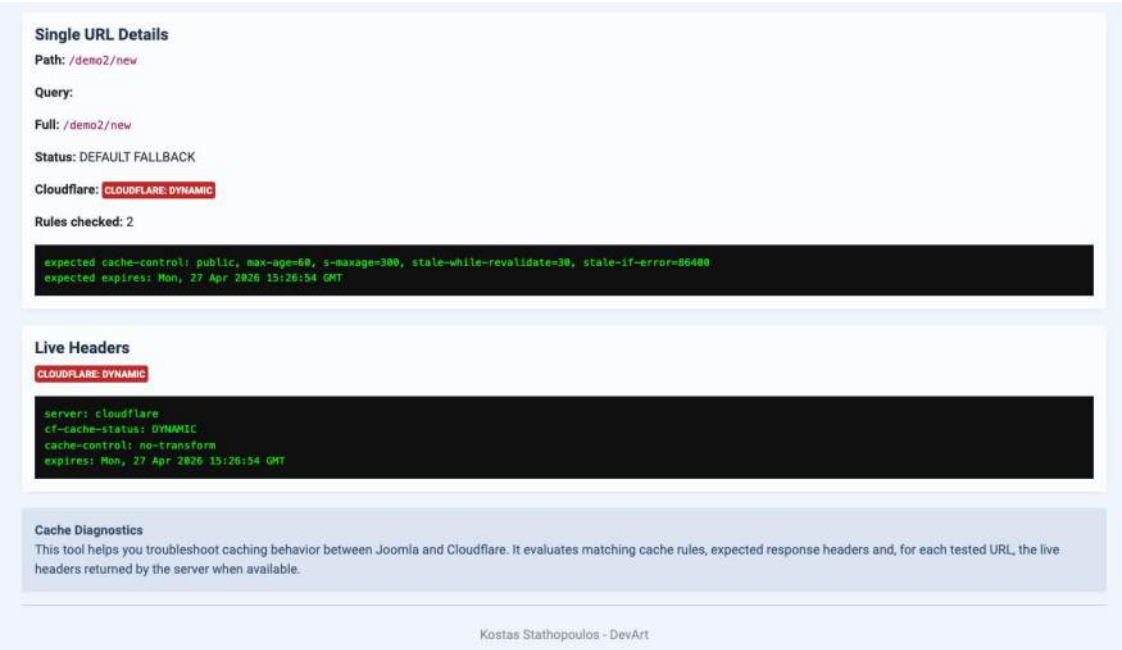
DYNAMIC

This means Cloudflare did not cache that request.

Reasons may include:

- no Cloudflare cache rule
- cookies present
- bypass conditions
- page excluded by Cloudflare





Multiple URL Example

You can test:

- Homepage
- RSS Feed
- Category Page

In one run.

This helps compare behavior quickly.

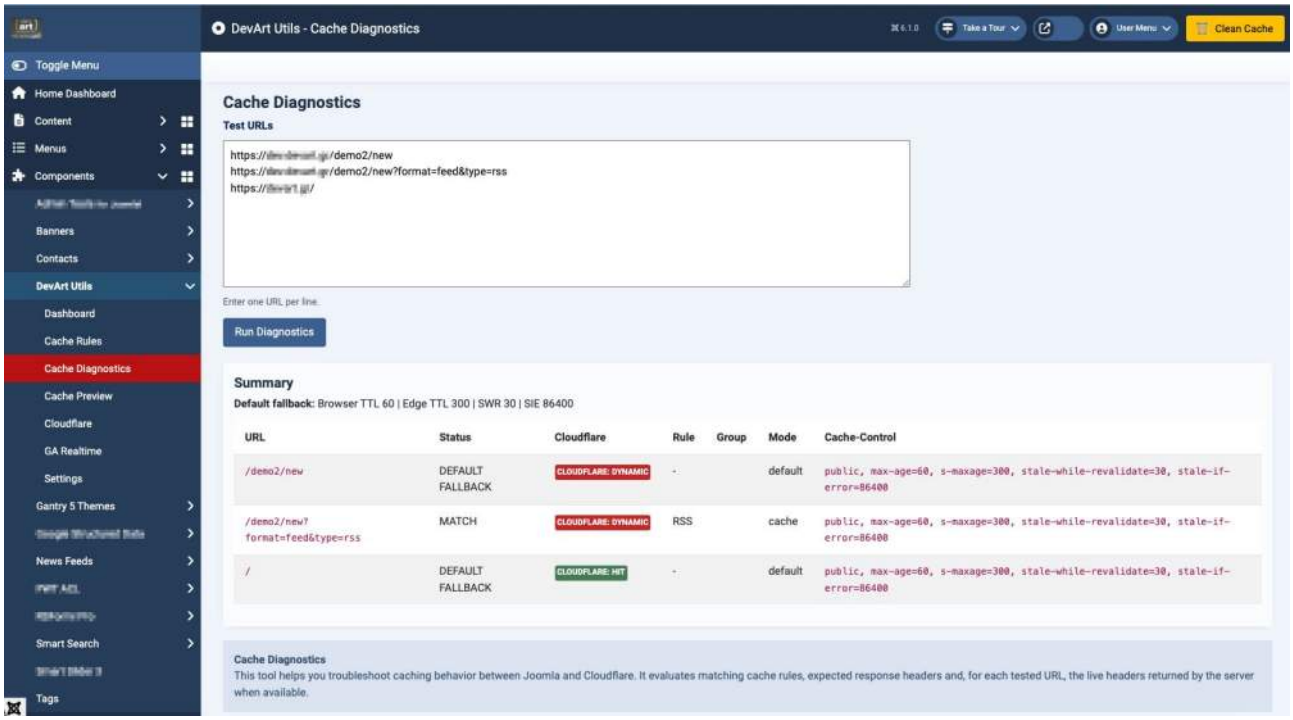
Very useful on large sites.

What You See In Details

Summary Table

Shows:

- URL
- Status
- Cloudflare status
- Matched Rule
- Group
- Mode
- Expected Cache-Control



Single URL Details

Shows:

- Path
- Query string
- Full URL
- Rule count checked
- Expected headers

Live Headers

Shows actual returned headers from server / Cloudflare such as:

- cf-cache-status
- cache-control
- expires

Why Results May Differ from Expected Values

Sometimes DevArt Utils shows expected values, but live headers are different.

This usually means another layer changed them after Joomla.

Examples:

Cloudflare Cache Rules

Cloudflare may override TTL and caching behavior.

Server Configuration

Apache / Nginx / LiteSpeed may add headers.

Security Plugins

Some tools add:

- no-transform
- no-store
- private

Reverse Proxies

Hosting CDN systems may modify headers.

Important Note

DevArt Utils shows:

Expected Values

What Joomla / plugin intends to send.

Live Values

What visitors actually receive.

Both are valuable.

3. Cache Preview

What Is Cache Preview?

Cache Preview is a simulation tool.

It does **not** purge cache.
It does **not** contact Cloudflare.
It does **not** fetch live headers.

It only shows which rule would match a URL based on your current DevArt Utils rules.

Why Use It?

Use Cache Preview before saving changes or while planning rules.

Perfect for testing:

- Will RSS match the RSS rule?
- Will admin URL bypass cache?
- Which rule wins first?
- Is my priority correct?

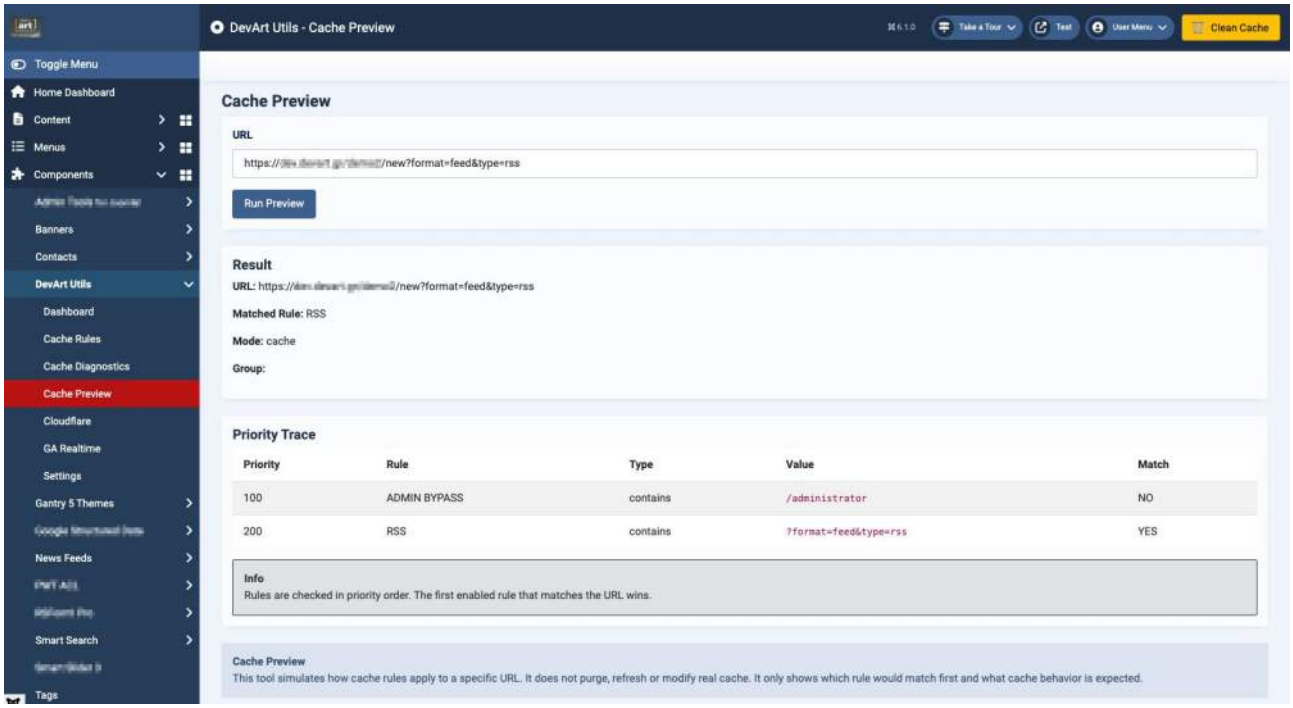
How To Use It

Go to:

DevArt Utils → Cache Preview

Enter a URL and click:

Run Preview



What It Shows

Result

- Tested URL
- Matched Rule
- Mode
- Group

Priority Trace

Shows all checked rules in order.

Example:

Priority	Rule	Match
100	ADMIN BYPASS	NO
200	RSS	YES

This clearly explains why a rule won.

Why It Is Useful

Cache Preview saves time.

Instead of testing real cache repeatedly, you can instantly verify logic.

Especially useful when many rules exist.

Recommended Workflow

Step 1

Use **Cache Preview** to test logic.

Step 2

Use **Cache Diagnostics** to verify real headers.

Step 3

Adjust priorities or match values if needed.

Final Advice

Keep your cache setup simple.

Use only necessary rules.
Name them clearly.
Use logical priorities.
Test regularly.

A clean caching strategy gives:

- faster Joomla sites
- better Cloudflare performance
- fewer server requests
- easier troubleshooting
- fewer support issues

Settings Overview

The **Settings** section of DevArt Utils is the central control panel for default cache behavior, optional integrations, system checks, and maintenance options.

These settings define how the extension works globally across your website.

Go to:

DevArt Utils → Settings

Why Settings Matter

Cache Rules apply to specific URLs, but the **Settings** page controls the default behavior used when no custom rule matches.

It also manages:

- Global cache values
- Logged-in user behavior
- Debug mode
- Uninstall data retention
- Toolbar clean cache menu
- Automatic cache cleaning
- Cloudflare connection
- Google Analytics Realtime integration
- System diagnostics

1. DevArt Cache Headers

This section controls the default HTTP caching headers sent by DevArt Utils.

These values are used when no specific Cache Rule overrides them.

Default Browser TTL (seconds)

Defines how long a visitor’s browser may keep cached files or pages locally.

Example:

- 60 = 1 minute
- 300 = 5 minutes
- 3600 = 1 hour

Recommended Usage

News websites:

60–300 seconds

Corporate / static sites:

1800–3600 seconds

Default Edge TTL (seconds)

Defines how long CDN systems such as Cloudflare may cache content at edge locations.

Example:

- 300 = 5 minutes
- 1800 = 30 minutes
- 7200 = 2 hours

Recommended Usage

Frequently updated content:

300–600

Stable content:

1800+

Default SWR (Stale While Revalidate)

Allows expired cached content to be served temporarily while fresh content is fetched in the background.

This improves speed and user experience.

Example:

30

Means users may receive the old cache briefly while a new version is generated.

Default SIE (Stale If Error)

Allows expired cache to be served if the origin server becomes unavailable.

Excellent for traffic spikes or temporary server errors.

Example:

86400 = 24 hours

Recommended for production websites.

Recommended Default Values

For most Joomla news / magazine websites:

- Browser TTL: 60
- Edge TTL: 300
- SWR: 30
- SIE: 86400

These values balance freshness and speed.

2. Cache Logged-in Users

Enable or disable cache behavior for logged-in users.

Yes

Logged-in users may receive cached content.

No

Logged-in users bypass cache.

Recommended

Usually **No** for most websites.

Use **Yes** only when logged-in users see mostly public content.

3. Debug Headers

Adds helpful response headers for troubleshooting.

Useful when testing with:

- browser developer tools
- curl
- proxy tools
- Cache Diagnostics

Recommended

- OFF in production
- ON during testing

4. Keep Data on Uninstall

If enabled, settings and data remain after uninstalling the extension.

Useful when:

- temporarily removing the extension
- reinstalling later
- migrations

If disabled, uninstall removes stored data.

Recommended

Enable if you may reinstall later.

5. Cache Cleaning

This section controls cache purge tools.

Enable Clean Cache Toolbar Menu

Shows the **Clean Cache** button in the Joomla administrator top toolbar.

This gives fast access to:

- Clear Joomla cache
- Clear Cloudflare cache (if connected)

Highly recommended for active websites.

Auto Clean on Article Save

Automatically clears Joomla cache when saving a Joomla article.

Useful for news websites where updates must appear quickly.

Recommended

Yes for editorial websites
Optional for static sites

6. Google Analytics Realtime

This optional feature connects DevArt Utils to Google Google Analytics 4 and displays live visitor data inside Joomla administrator.

Enable Google Analytics Realtime

Turns the feature on or off.

GA4 Property ID

Enter your Google Analytics Property ID.

Upload Service Account JSON

Upload the Google Cloud service account JSON file.

This file is stored encrypted in secure server-side storage.

Buttons

Replace JSON

Upload a new credentials file.

Remove JSON

Deletes stored credentials.

Test Connection

Checks whether the integration works correctly.

Recommended Setup

Use read-only credentials when possible.

7. System Check

This panel verifies compatibility.

Typical checks include:

- Joomla version
- PHP version
- cURL extension
- OpenSSL
- JSON support

Green **OK** status means everything is ready.

Why This Is Useful

If something does not work, this panel often reveals the reason immediately.

Example:

- old PHP version
- missing cURL
- disabled OpenSSL

8. Optional Integrations Status

This panel shows whether external services are connected.

Examples:

- Cloudflare API Token
- Cloudflare Zone Domain

- Purge Scope Host
- GA Realtime
- GA4 Property ID

Statuses such as:

- READY
- Missing
- Disabled

This gives a quick health overview.

9. System Info

Shows detected internal status such as:

- DevArt Cache Control Plugin
- DevArt Clean Cache Plugin
- Joomla Page Cache Plugin
- System Cache
- Cloudflare connection
- Google Analytics Realtime
- GA JSON uploaded
- Cache Time
- PHP Version
- Session Handler

Very useful for troubleshooting and support.

10. Cloudflare Connection Panel

This section manages the connection with Cloudflare.

Fields:

API Token

Your Cloudflare API token.

Used only when connecting or replacing credentials.

Stored encrypted.

Zone Domain

Main Cloudflare zone/domain.

Example:

mydomain.com

Purge Scope Host

Defines which hostname/subdomain should be purged by default.

Examples:

- mydomain.com
- news.mydomain.com
- shop.mydomain.com

Very useful for multi-site environments.

Buttons

Connect Cloudflare

Validates token and stores connection.

Disconnect Cloudflare

Removes connection.

Important Security Note

The main **Save** button does not modify stored API credentials.

Credentials are managed only through Connect / Disconnect actions.

Recommended Settings for Most Joomla News Sites

Cache

- Browser TTL: 60
- Edge TTL: 300
- SWR: 30
- SIE: 86400

User Cache

- Logged-in users: No

Maintenance

- Toolbar menu: Yes
- Auto clean article save: Yes

Debug

- Off normally
- On when troubleshooting

Recommended Settings for Static Business Websites

Cache

- Browser TTL: 1800
- Edge TTL: 3600+
- SWR: 60
- SIE: 86400

Maintenance

- Auto clean save: Optional

Best Practice Tips

Keep Settings Simple

Do not over-optimize small changes.

Use stable values first.

Use Cache Rules for Exceptions

Use Settings for defaults.

Use Cache Rules only for special URLs.

Test After Changes

Use:

- Cache Preview
- Cache Diagnostics

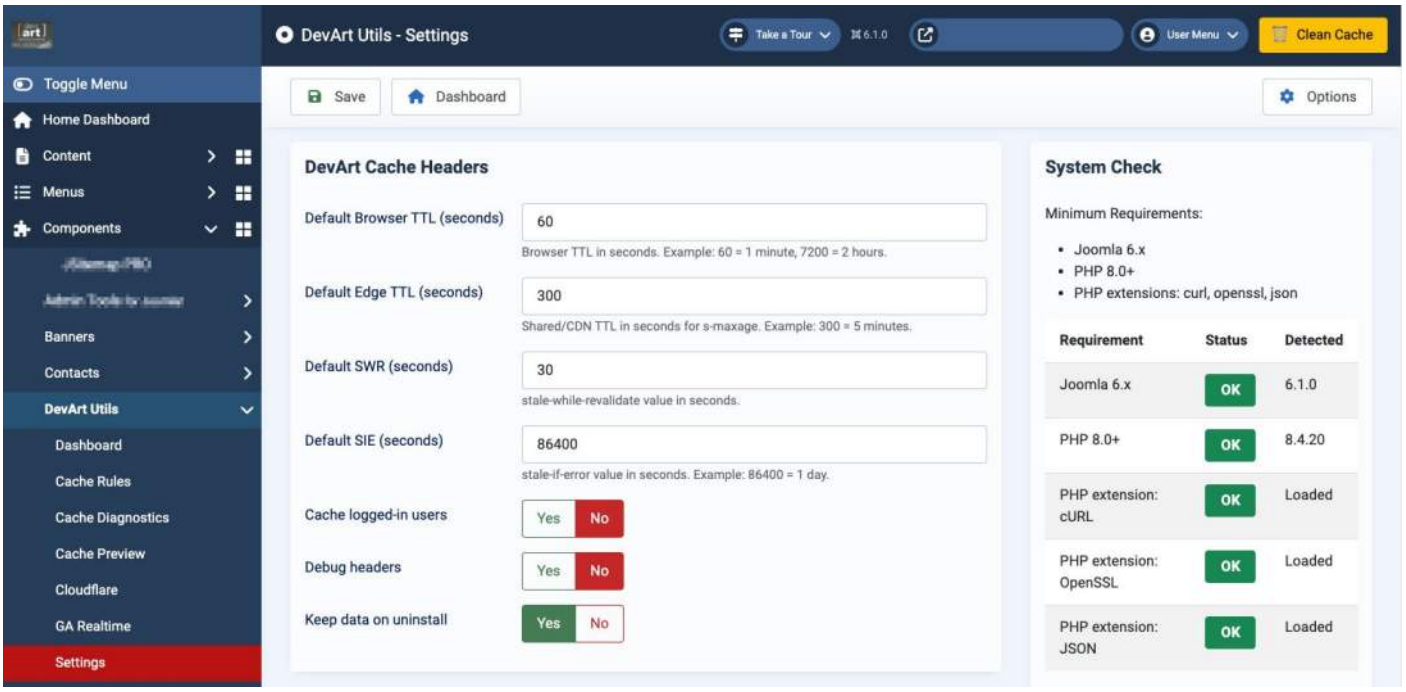
After major updates.

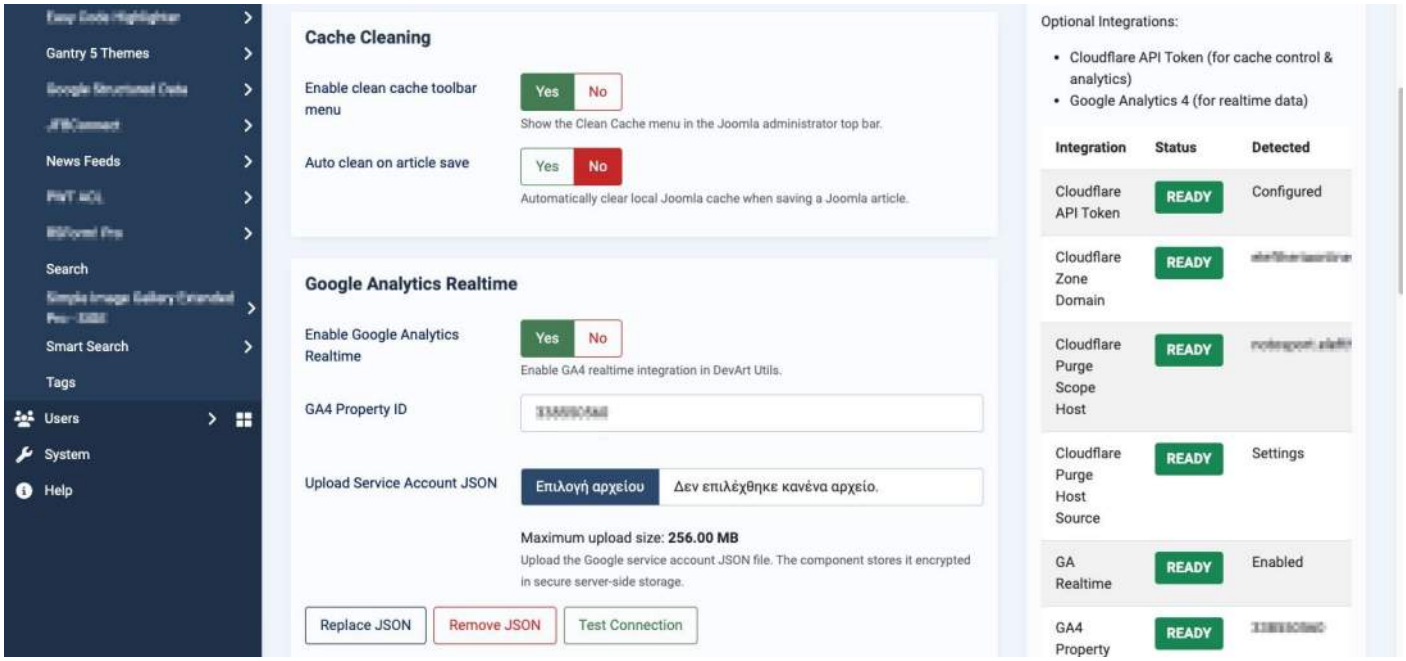
Final Advice

The Settings page is designed to give you safe defaults and fast administration.

A good configuration provides:

- Faster Joomla performance
- Better Cloudflare caching
- Easier maintenance
- Faster publishing workflow
- Useful live analytics
- Less troubleshooting later





LOW maximum	NORMAL maximum	HIGH maximum
19	149	399
0 up to this value = LOW	Above LOW maximum up to this value = NORMAL	Above NORMAL maximum up to this value = HIGH. Anything above becomes VERY HIGH.

Upload the service account JSON file here. DevArt Utils stores it automatically in a secure writable location when possible.

System Info

DevArt Cache Control Plugin	ON
DevArt Clean Cache Plugin	ON
Joomla Page Cache Plugin	ON
System Cache	ON
Cloudflare	ON
Google Analytics Realtime	ON
GA4 Property ID Set	ON

Exists

Instructions

DevArt Utils is an open-source toolkit for Joomla cache control, Cloudflare integration and diagnostics.

Google Analytics setup

1. Create a new project in Google Cloud.
2. Enable **Google Analytics Data API**.
3. Go to IAM & Admin → Service Accounts.
4. Create a new service account.
5. Open **Keys** → Add Key → Create new key → JSON.
6. Download the JSON file and upload it here.
7. In GA4, add the service account email to the property with read-only access.
8. Enter the GA4 Property ID in this page.

Cloudflare API setup

1. Open Cloudflare dashboard → My Profile → API Tokens.
2. Create a custom token.
3. Grant only the minimum permissions required, such as cache purge and read access for the selected zone.
4. Restrict the token to the specific zone/domain.
5. Copy the token and paste it into the Cloudflare settings field.

Use read-only access where possible, and always keep tokens limited to the specific domain or property they are intended for.

GA JSON Uploaded	ON
GA JSON File Exists	ON
Cache Time	15 minutes
PHP Version	8.4.20
Session Handler	Filesystem
Session Lifetime	[illegible]

Cloudflare

Cloudflare is connected.
The API token is stored encrypted and is managed only by Connect / Disconnect actions. The main Save button will not modify it.

API Token

Enter a Cloudflare API token only when connecting or replacing the stored token. The general Save button never updates this credential.

Zone Domain

[illegible]

Cloudflare zone/domain. Example: eleftheriaonline.gr

Purge Scope Host

[illegible]

Host/subdomain to purge by default.

Connect Cloudflare | Disconnect Cloudflare

Zone Domain defines the Cloudflare zone. Purge Scope Host defines the hostname/subdomain that DevArt Utils should purge by default.

Clean Cache Toolbar Menu & Understanding Multi-Level Cache

One of the most useful features of DevArt Utils is the **Clean Cache toolbar button** shown in the Joomla administrator top bar.

It gives administrators fast access to important cache actions without opening multiple pages.

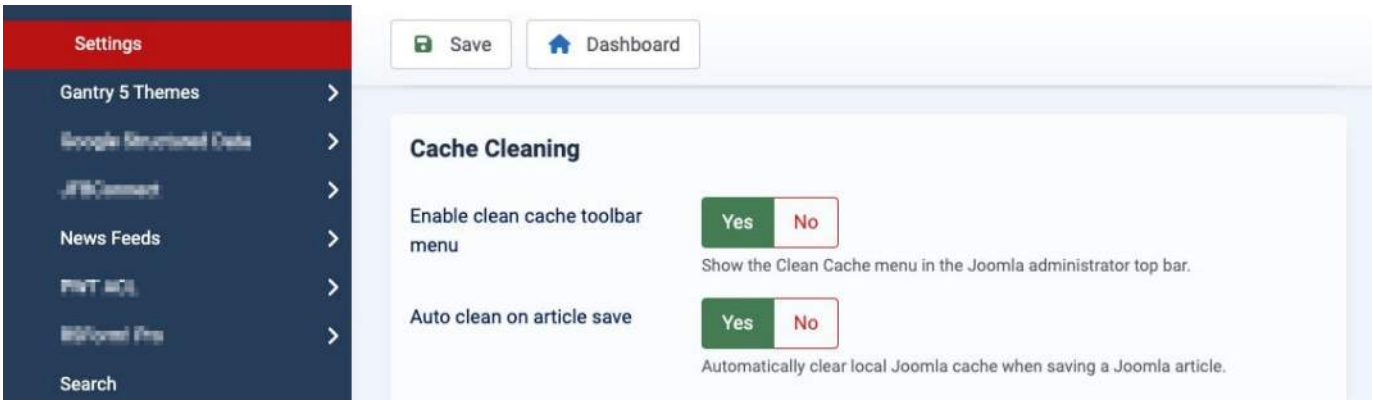
Go to:

DevArt Utils → Settings

Enable:

Enable clean cache toolbar menu = Yes

Once enabled, the button appears in the Joomla admin top toolbar.

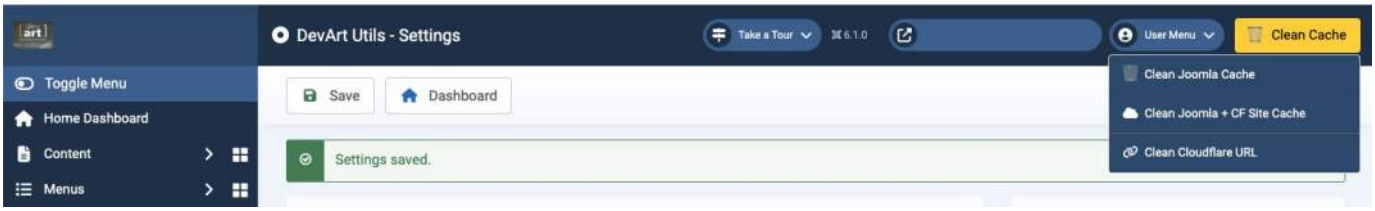


What the Clean Cache Button Does

The menu provides three actions:

1. Clean Joomla Cache
2. Clean Joomla + Cloudflare Site Cache
3. Clean Cloudflare URL

Each action serves a different purpose.



1. Clean Joomla Cache

This clears Joomla-generated cache stored on your server.

Examples may include:

- Page cache
- View cache
- Component output cache
- Cached module output
- Temporary rendered content

This does **not** clear Cloudflare cache.

When to Use It

Use this when:

- article updates do not appear internally
- module content is outdated
- menu changes are delayed
- Joomla is serving old cached pages

2. Clean Joomla + CF Site Cache

This is the recommended daily maintenance option.

It performs:

Step 1

Clears Joomla cache on the server.

Step 2

Purges the configured Cloudflare hostname / subdomain.

Examples:

- mydomain.com
- news.mydomain.com
- sports.mydomain.com

It does **not** necessarily purge the entire Cloudflare zone unless your configured purge scope is the root domain.

Why This Is Powerful

It refreshes both layers in the correct order:

1. Joomla creates fresh content
2. Cloudflare requests and caches the new version

Perfect after publishing new content.

3. Clean Cloudflare URL

This opens the targeted single-URL purge tool.

Use it to purge only one specific page.

Examples:

- Homepage
- Latest News page
- One article page
- One category page

This is the safest precision option.

Why This Matters

Instead of clearing everything, you refresh only what changed.

Better performance. Less server load.

Understanding Cache Layers (Very Important)

Many users think “cache” is one thing.

In reality, websites often use several layers at the same time.

Layer 1 – Joomla Internal Cache

Inside Joomla you may use:

Global Configuration Cache

Example:

- Conservative caching
- Progressive caching

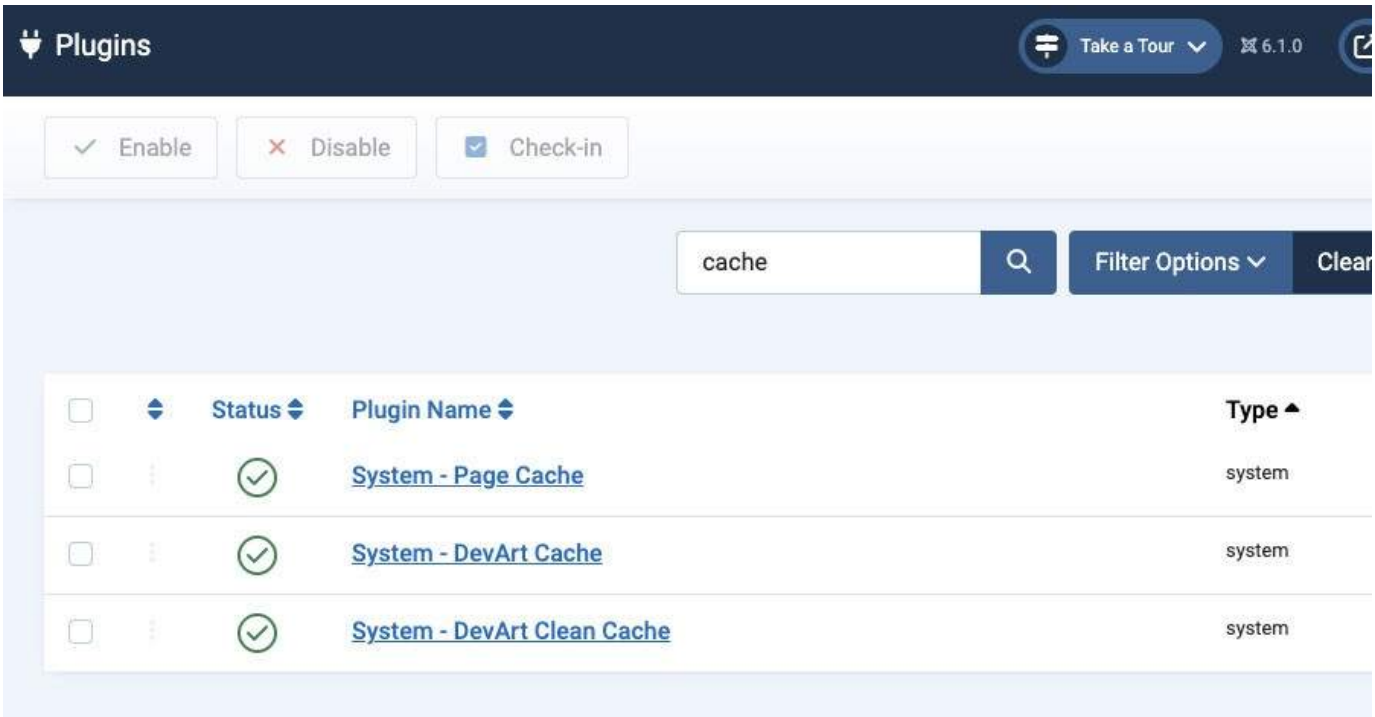
With a global cache time such as:

15 minutes

Page Cache Plugin

The **System - Page Cache** plugin may store full page output.

This can be very powerful.



Module Cache

Individual modules may have their own cache settings.

Example:

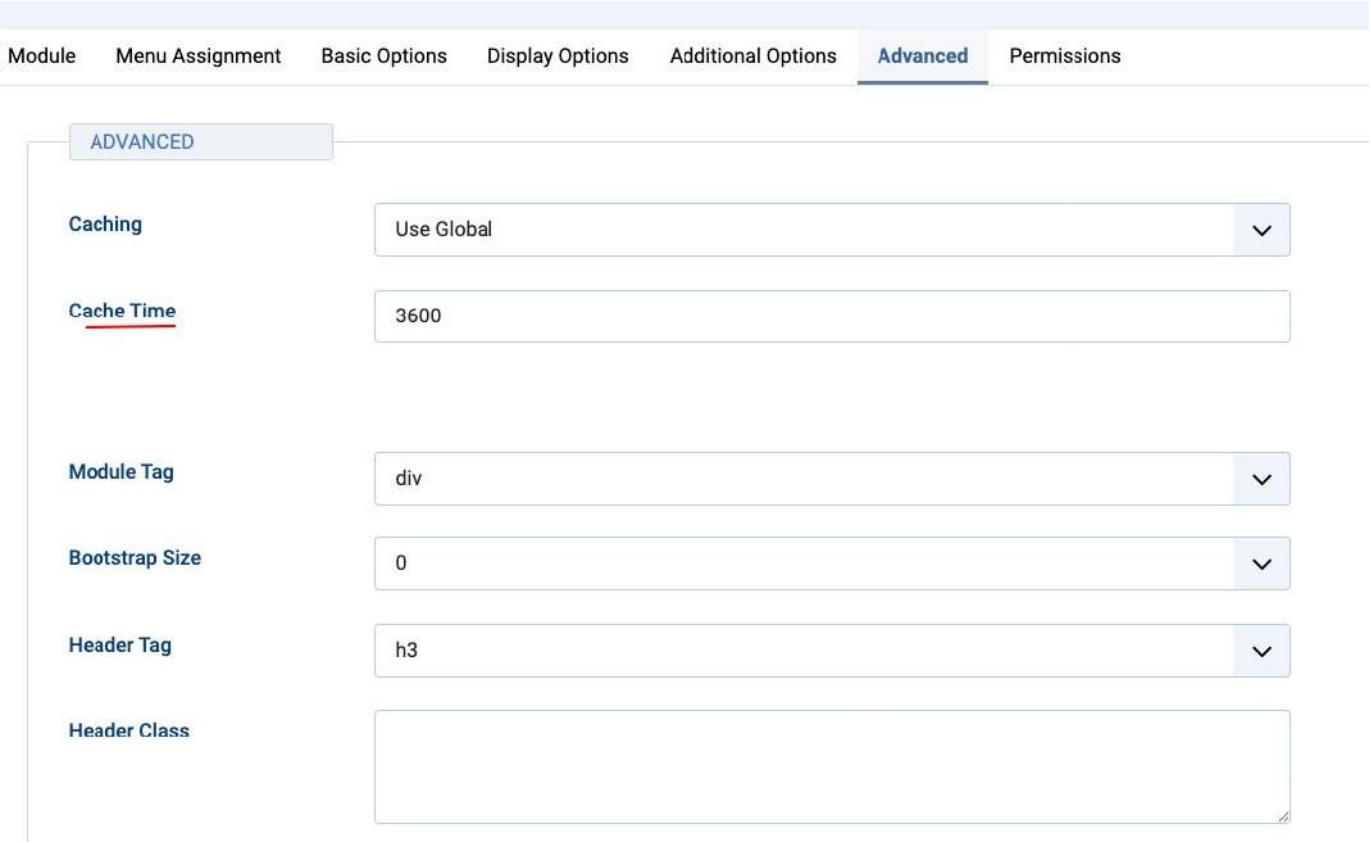
A module may cache for:

3600 seconds

while Joomla global cache is:

900 seconds

So not all content refreshes equally.



Layer 2 – Cloudflare Cache

Cloudflare may cache content at edge servers around the world.

Its behavior depends on:

- Cache Rules
- Edge TTL
- Page Rules
- Query string settings
- Cookie bypass rules
- Headers from Joomla

Layer 3 – Browser Cache

Visitors' browsers may also cache files and pages.

Examples:

- CSS
- JS
- images
- HTML depending on headers

Why Users Get Confused

Because clearing one layer does not always clear the others.

Example:

You clear Cloudflare only.

But Joomla still serves old cached page.

Cloudflare then stores the old version again.

Result:

No visible change.

Another Example

You clear Joomla only.

But Cloudflare still serves cached old page.

Visitors still do not see updates.

Another Example

Joomla and Cloudflare are fresh, but browser cache is old.

Visitor still sees outdated CSS or content.

Correct Logic

Fresh content must move through all layers properly:

Joomla → Cloudflare → Browser

If one layer still holds old data, updates may not appear.

Why the Combined Button Is Useful

Clean Joomla + CF Site Cache solves the most common problem:

1. Clears Joomla first
2. Then clears Cloudflare

This lets Cloudflare cache a fresh version immediately.

Real Publishing Example

You publish breaking news on homepage.

Use:

Clean Joomla + CF Site Cache

or

Purge only:

- homepage URL
- latest news page

When NOT to Purge Everything

Do not constantly purge all Cloudflare cache.

Why:

- extra origin load
- slower responses
- unnecessary traffic to server

Especially bad on busy websites.

Smart Purging Strategy

New Article

Purge:

- article URL
- homepage if featured
- category page if needed

Module Update

Clear Joomla cache first.

CSS / template changes

May require Cloudflare purge and browser refresh.

Module Cache Can Mislead You

If a homepage module caches for 1 hour:

Even after clearing Cloudflare, Joomla may still output the old module content.

So Cloudflare caches the old module again.

This is why understanding module cache matters.

Recommended Setup for News Sites

Joomla

- Moderate internal cache times
- Auto clear on article save enabled

Cloudflare

- Smart Edge TTL
- Targeted purges

Browser

- Reasonable browser TTL

Recommended Daily Workflow

Publish new article

Use:

Clean Joomla + CF Site Cache

or targeted URL purge.

Edit old article

Use:

Clean Cloudflare URL (article only)

Design changes

Use broader purge if needed.

Simple Rule to Remember

If Joomla still has old content, Cloudflare cannot invent new content.

If Cloudflare still has old content, visitors will not see Joomla updates.

When Joomla cache, Cloudflare cache, module cache, and browser cache combine without strategy, troubleshooting becomes difficult.

That is exactly why DevArt Utils provides quick purge tools and diagnostics—to make complex caching manageable.

Creating a Cloudflare API Token for DevArt Utils

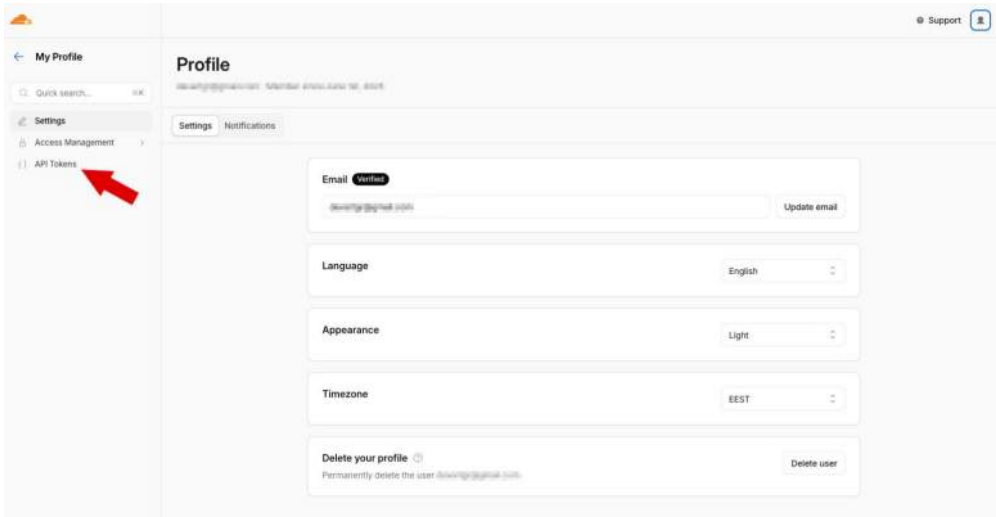
To connect DevArt Utils with Cloudflare, you need to create a Cloudflare API Token with the correct permissions.

Follow the steps below carefully.

1. Open Your Cloudflare Profile

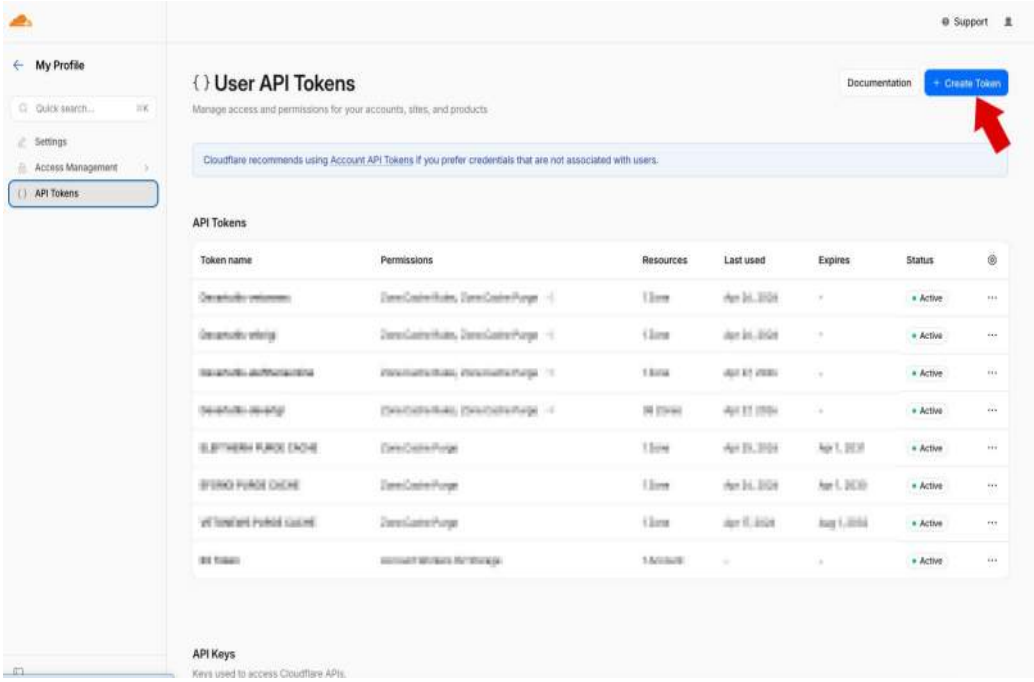
Log in to your Cloudflare account.

Go to your **Profile** and select **API Tokens**.



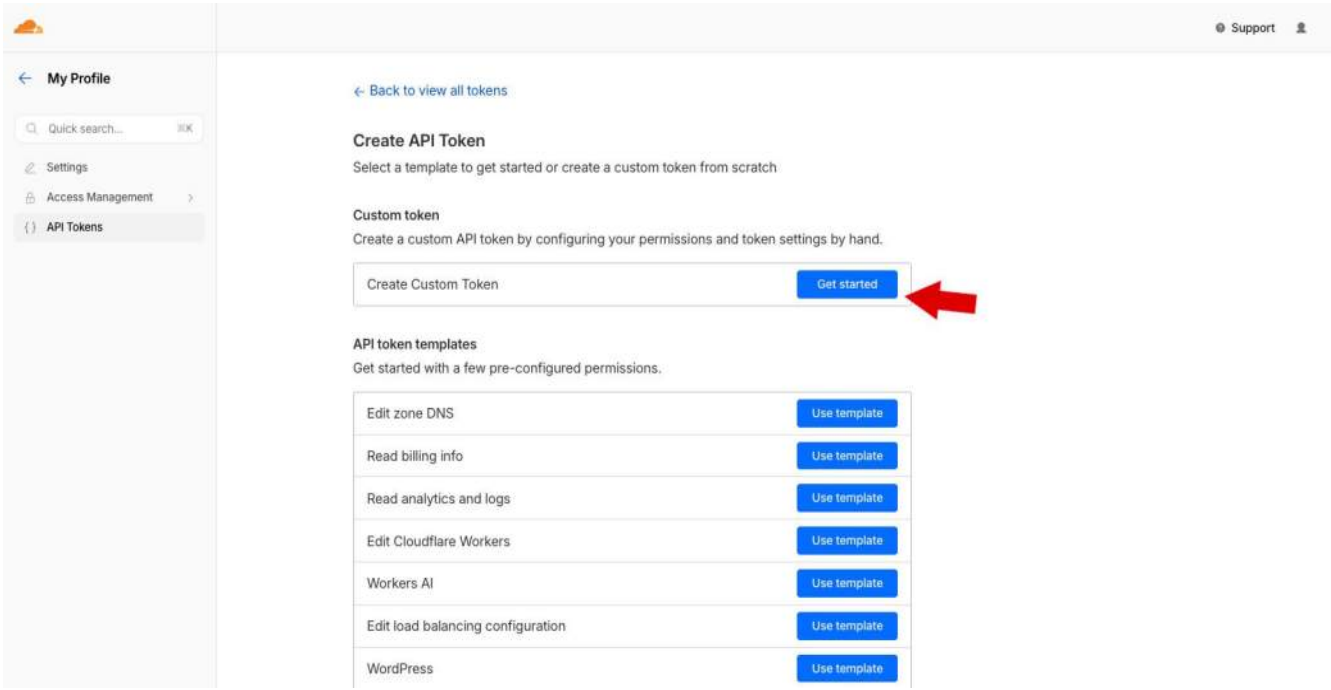
2. Create a New Token

Click the **Create Token** button.



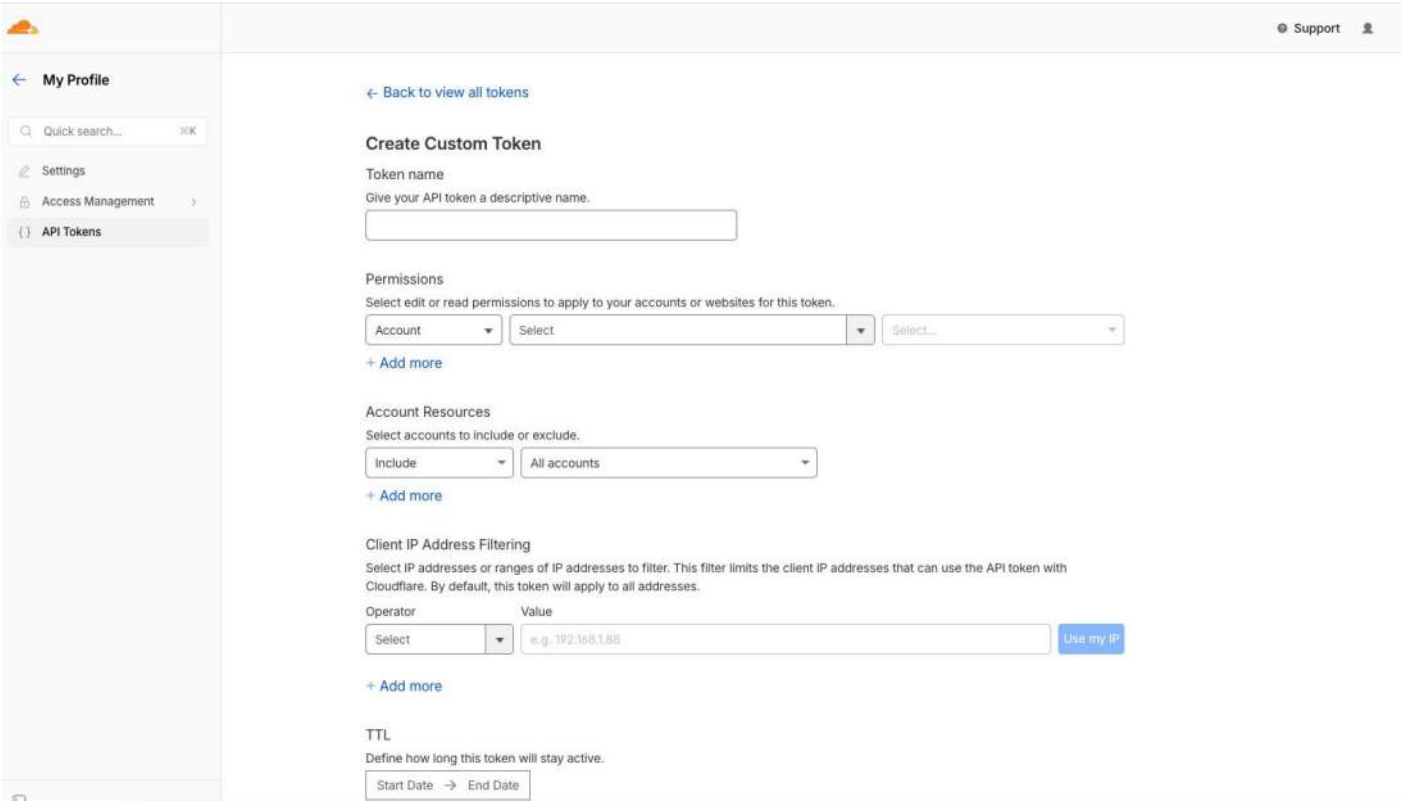
3. Create a Custom Token

Select **Create Custom Token** and click **Get Started**.



4. Configure the Token

Enter a name for the token, then configure the following settings:



A. Permissions

Add these permissions:

- **Zone - Cache Rules - Read**
- **Zone - Cache Purge - Purge**
- **Zone - Page Rules - Read**
- **Zone - Analytics - Read**

These permissions allow DevArt Utils to read cache settings, purge cache, and display analytics data.

B. Zone Resources

Choose:

Include → Specific zone

Then select your domain name.

Example:

- domain1.com

Using One Token for Multiple Websites

If you want to use the same API Token with multiple websites, simply add all required Zone/domains.

Example:

- domain1.com
- domain2.com
- domain3.com

C. Client IP Address Filtering (Optional)

For additional security, you may restrict API access only to the IP addresses of the server where Joomla is installed.

This is recommended for production environments.

D. TTL (Optional)

Leave **TTL** empty unless you want the token to expire automatically in the future.

5. Final Step – Save the Token

Continue through the final confirmation steps and create the token.

Important:
Cloudflare will show the token **only once** for security reasons.

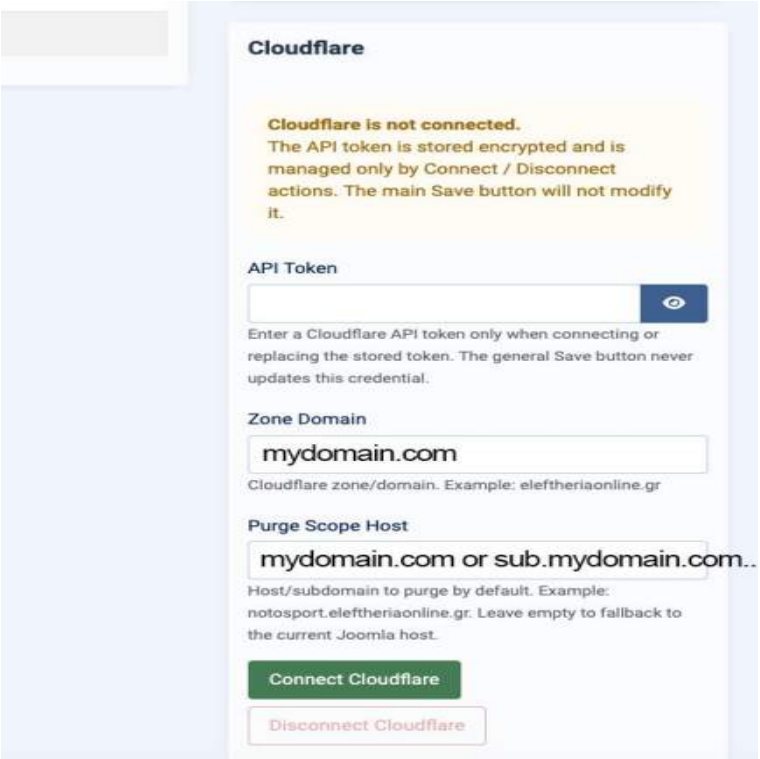
Save it in a secure location.
If you lose it, you must create a new token.

Connecting the Token Inside DevArt Utils

Go to:

DevArt Utils → Settings → Cloudflare

Fill in the following fields, click Connect Cloudflare and Save buttons:



API Token

Paste the token you created in the previous steps.

Zone Domain

Enter the main domain that was selected in **Zone Resources**.

Example:

- domain1.com

If you add more domains later, you can edit the token in Cloudflare.

Purge Scope Host

Usually, enter the same domain as **Zone Domain**.

However, if your Joomla website is installed on a subdomain, enter that subdomain instead.

Example: Multiple Joomla Installations

Imagine you have four Joomla installations:

- mydomain.com
- subdomain1.mydomain.com
- subdomain2.mydomain.com
- subdomain3.mydomain.com

Use:

Zone Domain
mydomain.com

(on all four Joomla installations)

Use **Purge Scope Host** separately on each installation:

- mydomain.com
- subdomain1.mydomain.com
- subdomain2.mydomain.com
- subdomain3.mydomain.com

Why This Is Useful

This setup allows each Joomla installation to:

- Purge the full Cloudflare cache if needed
- Purge only the main domain cache
- Purge only its own subdomain cache
- Avoid affecting cache on other subdomains

This is especially useful for multi-site or large publishing environments.

Creating the GA4 Service Account JSON and Finding the Property ID

To use the **GA Realtime** feature in DevArt Utils, you need two things:

1. A **Google Analytics 4 Property ID**
2. A **Google Cloud Service Account JSON file**

DevArt Utils uses these to read realtime analytics data from GA4 and display it inside the Joomla administrator area.

1. Enable the Google Analytics Data API

Go to:

Google Cloud Console → APIs & Services → Library

Search for:

Google Analytics Data API

Open it and click:

Enable

The Google Analytics Data API is required because GA4 realtime reports are accessed through this API.

2. Create a Service Account

Go to:

Google Cloud Console → IAM & Admin → Service Accounts

Click:

Create Service Account

Enter a name, for example:

DevArt Utils GA Realtime

Then complete the creation process.

A service account is used so DevArt Utils can access GA4 data securely without using your personal Google login.

3. Create and Download the JSON Key

Open the service account you created.

Go to:

Keys → Add Key → Create New Key

Choose:

JSON

Click:

Create

Google will download a `.json` file to your computer.

Keep this file safe. It contains private credentials and should not be shared publicly. Google notes that service account keys must be managed carefully because they can be a security risk if exposed.

4. Add the Service Account to GA4

Open:

Google Analytics → Admin

Select the correct GA4 property.

Go to:

Property Access Management

Click:

Add user

Paste the service account email address.

You can find this email inside the JSON file or in Google Cloud. It usually looks like this:

```
devart-utils-ga@your-project-id.iam.gserviceaccount.com
```

Give it read-only access, such as:

Viewer

This allows DevArt Utils to read realtime analytics data without changing your GA4 settings. Google's Analytics API setup also requires granting the service account access to the Analytics property.

5. Find the GA4 Property ID

Go to:

Google Analytics → Admin → Property Settings

Select the correct property.

Copy the **Property ID**.

Important: this is a numeric ID, for example:

```
123456789
```

Do not confuse this with the Measurement ID, which starts with `G-`. For the GA4 Data API, the property is identified by the numeric GA4 Property ID.

6. Add the Information in DevArt Utils

Go to:

DevArt Utils → Settings → Google Analytics Realtime

Fill in:

GA4 Property ID

Paste the numeric GA4 Property ID.

Example:

```
123456789
```

Upload Service Account JSON

Upload the JSON file you downloaded from Google Cloud.

Then click:

Test Connection

If everything is correct, DevArt Utils will be able to display realtime GA4 data.

Important Notes

Do not upload the Google tag ID here.

Wrong:

```
G-XXXXXXXXXX
```

Correct:

```
123456789
```

The `G-` ID is used for website tracking code, while the numeric Property ID is used by the API. Google's Analytics Help explains that the `G-` value is the Measurement ID for the web data stream, not the API property ID.

Security Recommendation

Use the minimum access required.

For GA Realtime, the service account only needs read access to the selected GA4 property.

Do not give unnecessary administrator permissions.